

Data Manipulation and Exploratory Data Analysis

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Course : ADS 201 D2
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1. Introduction

Before any complex machine learning models can be trained or statistical inferences can be made, raw data must be properly ingested, structured, and understood. This assignment focuses on the earliest stages of the data pipeline: Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) and fundamental data wrangling. By utilizing both Python (Pandas) and R, this exercise demonstrates how programmatic tools are used to transform a raw CSV file into a structured, interpretable format.

2. Objective

The primary goal of this assignment is to build a strong, working intuition for data manipulation from first principles. Specifically, the objectives are to:

- Successfully load remote datasets into a programmatic environment.
- Extract structural metadata (dimensions, column names, and summary statistics).
- Perform feature engineering using vectorized operations to create new metrics.
- Apply conditional logic to categorize data points.
- Sort and organize the dataset to quickly identify patterns and validate transformations.

3. Procedure

The assignment was executed through a sequence of three core tasks, implemented in both Python and R to compare syntax and methodology:

- **Task 1: Load and Explore Data**
 - Sourced a standard CSV dataset from a remote URL.
 - Loaded the dataset into a DataFrame (Python) and Data Frame (R).
 - Displayed the first five rows to visually inspect the data structure.
 - Extracted and printed the column names and the overall matrix dimensions (rows and columns).
 - Generated summary statistics to evaluate the central tendency, spread, and potential missing values within the numerical columns.
- **Task 2: Creating New Columns (Feature Engineering)**
 - Derived a new continuous variable, **Average Score**, by mathematically combining two existing numeric columns (**Age** and **Fare**).

- Implemented conditional logic to create a new categorical feature, **Status**. A threshold was set so that an **Average Score** strictly greater than 30 was labeled "High," while all other values were labeled "Low."
- **Task 3: Sorting Data**
 - Reordered the entire dataset based on the newly created **Average Score** column in ascending order.
 - Extracted the top five rows of the sorted dataset to verify that the conditional categorization ("Low" vs. "High") aligned perfectly with the numerical sorting.

4. Outcome

The procedure successfully transformed a raw CSV file into a richer, more organized dataset. The initial exploration revealed the underlying distribution of the data. The feature engineering phase successfully vectorized mathematical operations across the entire dataset without relying on inefficient row-by-row loops. Finally, the sorting operation provided a clean, organized view of the dataset, confirming that the conditional logic was applied accurately and that the row-wise integrity of the data was maintained throughout the transformations.

5. Conclusion

Mastering these fundamental data structures and operations is a critical stepping stone for any advanced analytical work. By manually programming the data ingestion, feature creation, and ordering processes, it becomes much easier to understand how data behaves under the hood. The intuition developed through these basic operations directly translates to handling larger, more complex datasets required for predictive modeling, system design, and rigorous statistical testing.